Fallen Keep of the Emerald Knight

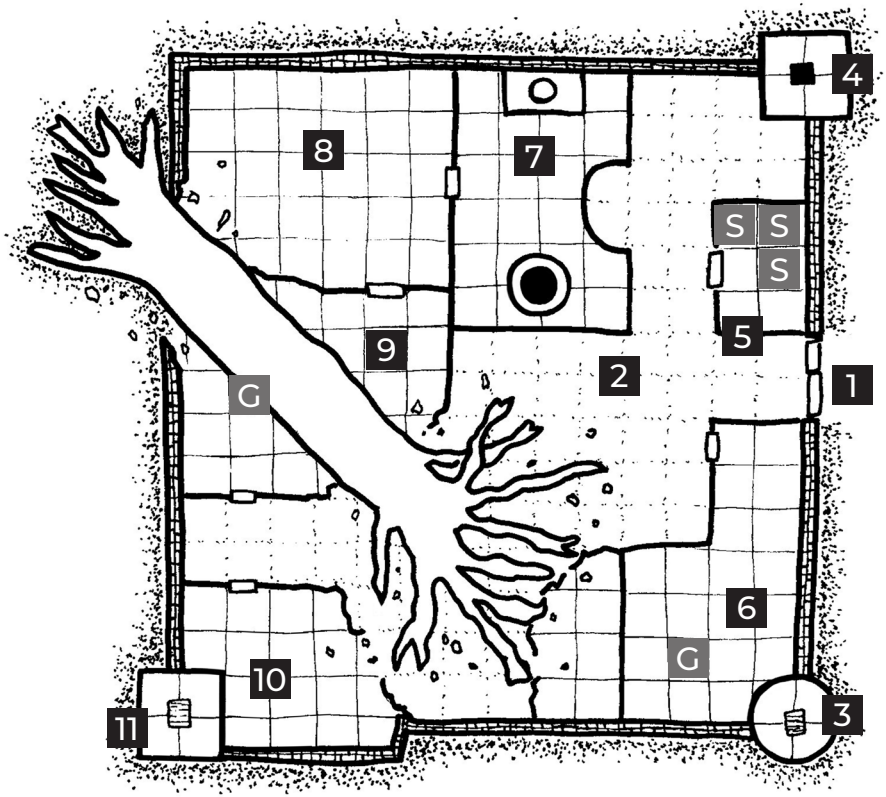
Toil and trouble, ruin and rubble! Cross a witch and pay in pain... the keep will never be whole again!

The **Emerald Knight** has perished, his life crushed by the fall of an ancient oak. His shattered keep has since become an accursed place of ill omen! What secrets and treasures lie buried in the ruins of this abandoned forest redoubt?

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

d4	Details
1	A **giant spider** skitters out of the shadows
2	Three masked **bandits** hold the PCs up for their valuables
3	A **swarm of bats** whirls in
4	A ghostly wind snuffs all light!

The Curse. A witch used her dying breath to curse the keep with constant ruin and bad fortune. Unless her bones are removed from the well in Area 6 and properly buried, **luck tokens** cannot be used within the keep's confines.



Walls: 15' high, DC 12 DEX to climb

Towers: 30' high, DC 12 DEX to climb

Shadowdark RPG

1st-Level

K. Dionne, 2026

1. Gate. Rusted iron gate woven with **vines** (gate swings freely if vines are cut away). A **black cat** with bright yellow eyes sits atop the gate, watching. It flees if threatened. If treated well, it speaks in Common before slipping away: "My mistress is trapped in the well."

2. Courtyard. Weed-cracked cobbles stained by rain. Fuzzy lumps of moss bristle along the stone walls and roofs of the interior buildings. A towering, dead **oak** tree lies amid crushed masonry in the southern half of the courtyard. An iron knitting needle driven flush into its center is actually a *Wand of Sending*.

3. Round Tower. A hay-stuffed **scarecrow** (*Shadowdark RPG* pg. 249) with a floppy hat and menacing grin leers out over the wall. It comes alive if attacked or if anyone tries to climb the tower walls (it won't leave its post). A swollen wood **trapdoor** (DC 12 STR to open) reveals stairs down to Area 6.

4. North Tower. Cracked and crumbling tower with sagging floor. Prickly-leafed, lavender **vines** erupt from an open passage down (DC 12 CON on first touch or dizzy and weak for 1d4 rounds). Inside is a drop (30') enclosed by a thick curtain of the vines. A leaf-covered archway at the bottom exits to Area 2.

5. Gatehouse. Three jovial **skeletons** in rotted green robes and rusty armor play dice at a table around a pile of 20 gp. They don't realize they're dead and invite all comers to the game.

6. Rectory. Friar Tomin (**ghoul**) lurches around his bedchamber in shredded green robes snarling angrily to himself. He obsessively dusts the furniture and attacks anyone who refuses to join in.

7. Chapel of Saint Martin. Dust gathers thick as snow on the shoulders of a stately, bronze knight **statue** wearing an antler-horned helm (St. Martin). A gold **tabernacle** worth 20 gp rests in an alcove behind him, its surface marred by a black cat-eye symbol (see **trap** below). Opposite the statue is a **well** full of greenish-black water (20' deep). The **witch's bones** rest in a pale mound on the bottom. Properly burying them ends The Curse. The black cat (Area 1) then brings a pair of *Boots of the Cat* to the group during their next rest.

- **Tabernacle Trap.** DC 18 DEX to pick open, which releases swamp gas; all in near DC 12 CON or 1d4 damage.

8. Barracks. Rainwater puddles stand amid collapsing bunks and tattered green wall banners. An intact **chest** contains 30 gp wrapped in a white silk handkerchief monogrammed "H.T."

9. Grand Bedchamber. The oak tree (Area 2) fell through the ceiling, crushing a four-post **bed** of decayed emerald silks and velvets. A figure in a nightgown squirms beneath its trunk, mewling for help. This is the trapped Emerald Knight (now a **ghast**).

10. Mess Hall. Four whithered bodies in rusty armor and green robes sit dead at a feasting table, hands clutched around their own throats. A black cat-eye **symbol** is scrawled on the inside door.

11. West Tower. A corpse wearing the decayed remains of a helm and leather armor lies on its back in a corner. Something pale shines in its mouth behind missing teeth (a 40 gp pearl). The swollen wood **trapdoor** (DC 12 STR to open) reveals stairs down to Area 10.